

Resolution

ENROLLED SENATE
CONCURRENT
RESOLUTION NO. 20

By: Pugh of the Senate

and

Kerbs of the House

A Concurrent Resolution congratulating the YMCA on 175 years of service; recognizing its role in strengthening communities; commending its staff and volunteers; and encouraging continued efforts to promote well-being and connection.

WHEREAS, the Young Men's Christian Association (YMCA) marks its 175th anniversary, having been founded in the United States by Thomas Valentine Sullivan in Boston on December 29, 1851, with a mission to put Christian principles into practice by building a healthy spirit, mind, and body for all; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA has continually adapted to meet the evolving needs of American communities, strengthening society by bringing people together, fostering relationships, and creating a sense of belonging; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy includes providing safe housing during the Industrial Revolution, pioneering the first night school and English as a Second Language classes, inventing basketball, and delivering the first group swim lessons; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA's legacy also includes establishing the Youth and Government program, serving as the birthplace of Father's Day, and becoming the nation's leading nonprofit provider of child care and after-school programs to support working families; and

WHEREAS, today nearly 2,600 YMCAs serve more than 10,000 communities, with more than 300,000 staff and 350,000 volunteers

delivering essential programs to over 17 million people annually;
and

WHEREAS, the Oklahoma Alliance of YMCAs amplifies the work of nine independent YMCAs through a shared commitment to strengthening communities by connecting people to their potential, purpose, and each other; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA of Greater Oklahoma City, founded in 1889 and one of the earliest civic organizations formed after the Land Run, was the first YMCA in Oklahoma; and

WHEREAS, Oklahoma YMCAs have more than 3,600 staff and nearly 7,000 volunteers providing essential programs and services to 37 communities; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA is a leader in aquatics (water safety and swim lessons), child care, youth sports, meal programs, and health and wellness initiatives, and is the largest provider of fitness programs for older adults; and

WHEREAS, the YMCA creates welcoming spaces for people of all ages, backgrounds, and abilities.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE 2ND SESSION OF THE 60TH OKLAHOMA LEGISLATURE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING THEREIN:

THAT the Oklahoma Legislature congratulates and expresses appreciation to the YMCA for 175 years of service to the nation.

THAT the Oklahoma Legislature recognizes the YMCA's role in responding to community needs, fostering relationships, and building a sense of belonging.

THAT the Oklahoma Legislature commends the staff and volunteers who create connected communities and advance the YMCA's mission.

THAT the Oklahoma Legislature encourages continued support for the efforts to address social isolation and loneliness by creating places that promote well-being and help people build relationships and thrive.

Adopted by the Senate the 16th day of April, 2026.

Presiding Officer of the Senate

Adopted by the House of Representatives the 16th day of April,
2026.

Presiding Officer of the House
of Representatives

OFFICE OF THE SECRETARY OF STATE

Received by the Office of the Secretary of State this _____
day of _____, 20 _____, at _____ o'clock _____ M.
By: _____